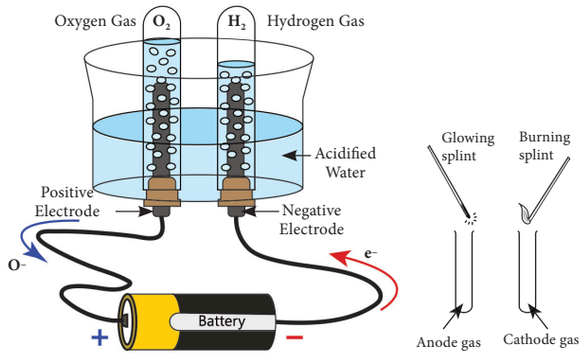


Figure 13.1 Electrolysis of Water

filled with a particular gas. If the gas collected is tested using a burning splint we can notice that the gas in cathode side burns with a popping sound when the extinguish splint is brought near the mouth of the test tube. This property is usually shown by hydrogen gas and so it is confirmed that the gas inside the test tube is hydrogen. The burning splint placed near the anode side burns more brightly confirming that it is oxygen gas. This experiment shows that water is made up of hydrogen and oxygen. The ratio of hydrogen and oxygen is 2:1. Hence, for every two volumes of hydrogen collected at the cathode, there is one volume of oxygen collected at the anode.

$$2H_2O \xrightarrow{\text{Electrolysis}} 2H_2\uparrow + O_2\uparrow$$

Activity 1

Take some anhydrous copper (II) sulphate powder and place it in a watch glass. Add water drop by drop to the anhydrous copper (II) sulphate. Do you notice any colour change in the powder? You can notice the powder turning blue. It is a test for water.



Anhydrous copper (II) sulphate **Hydrated copper (II) sulphate**

13.1.2 Preparation of Water

Water was first prepared in 1781 by an English scientist Henry Cavendish. He discovered hydrogen gas when active metals reacted with sulphuric acid. The hydrogen gas released was highly inflammable and burnt to form a colourless product called water.

$$Zn + H_2SO_4 \longrightarrow ZnSO_4 + H_2\uparrow$$

$$2H_2 + O_2 \longrightarrow 2H_2O$$

Water is also produced by the reduction of metal oxide by hydrogen, burning of hydrogen in air and burning of hydrocarbons in air. Respiration of plants and animals also releases water.

$$\underset{\text{Glucose}}{C_6H_{12}O_6} + \underset{\text{Oxygen}}{6O_2} \longrightarrow \underset{\text{Carbon dioxide}}{6CO_2} + \underset{\text{Water}}{\mathbf{6H_2O}} + \text{Energy}$$



Henry Cavendish was a British philosopher, scientist, chemist, and physicist. Cavendish is noted for his discovery of hydrogen. He called it inflammable air. He mixed metals with strong acids and created hydrogen. He created carbon dioxide also by combining metals with strong bases.



13.1.3 Laboratory preparation of water

The apparatus used for the preparation of water in the laboratories is as shown in Figure 13.2. In this method, pure hydrogen gas is passed through anhydrous calcium chloride to absorb water vapour, if present. Dry hydrogen coming out of the opening is burnt with sufficient supply of air. The burnt hydrogen gas forms droplets of water, when it comes in contact with the cold flask. Distilled water without any dissolved matter is obtained by this method.

8th_Science_Unit-13_EM.indd 140 12/8/2022 3:07:58 PM